The Decision- Making Advantage :

How Successful Professionals Navigate Uncertainty In Complex Environments

Developing a practical decision-making framework by studying how professionals navigate uncertainty across diverse domains.

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STUDY APPROACH & METHODOLOGY

OBJECTIVE

Our team conducted a cross-domain qualitative study to understand how experienced professionals make effective decisions under uncertainty. Guided by established decision-making literature, we designed semi-structured interviews to identify recurring decision-making patterns across diverse industries. These common patterns were synthesized into the Decision-Making Advantage Framework (DMAF), a practical framework for structured decision-making in complex environments

STEP I: THEORETICAL GROUNDING

Established a conceptual foundation through a comprehensive literature review on decision-making under uncertainty.

CORE LITERATURE

- *Thinking, Fast and Slow* – Daniel Kahneman
- *Sources of Power* – Gary Klein
- *Noise* – Kahneman, Sibony & Sunstein
- *How Doctors Think* – Jerome Groopman

SUPPORTING REFERENCES

- Harvard Business Review (Decision-Making)
- MIT Sloan Management Review
- McKinsey Quarterly
- World Economic Forum – *Future of Jobs Report 2025*

STEP II: PRIMARY QUALITATIVE INTERVIEWS

Conducted five semi-structured interviews using a 12-question interview guide based on 10 decision-making dimensions.

Domain	Interviewee
Healthcare	*Mr. S. K. Ahmed Raza & Dr. Noopur Gupta*
Banking	*CA Yashvi Pandey*
Education	*Fr. Nobit B.K.*
Public Adm.	*G. Mouni Sreedhar*
Civil Engineering	*Mr. Pradeep Jha*

STUDY STATISTICS

5 Interviews • 5 Professional Domains • 12 Interview Questions • 10 Decision-Making Dimensions

STEP III: SYNTHESIS & FRAMEWORK DEVELOPMENT

Interview responses were analyzed using a qualitative approach:

Thematic Coding

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Cross-Case Analysis

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Pattern Identification

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Decision-Making Advantage Framework (DMAF)

STUDY WORKFLOW

Literature Review ➤ Interview Guide Design ➤ Primary Data Collection ➤ Thematic Coding ➤ Cross-Case Analysis ➤ Decision-Making Advantage Framework (DMAF)

Sources: GP1 Project Proposal; Team 27 Primary Interview Reports (2026); Daniel Kahneman (2011); Gary Klein (1998); Jerome Groopman (2007); Harvard Business Review; MIT Sloan Management Review; World Economic Forum – Future of Jobs Report 2025.

ANALYSIS: FROM INTERVIEWS TO KEY INSIGHTS

INTRODUCTION Cross-domain analysis integrating primary interviews with established decision-making literature

DEFINE THE RIGHT PROBLEM

PRIMARY EVIDENCE

Healthcare

- **Dr. Noopur Gupta:** “*Treatment was available, but accessibility was the real challenge.*”
- **Mr. S. K. Ahmed Raza:** “*Community needs were identified before designing interventions.*”

Civil Engineering

- **Mr. Pradeep Jha:** “*Engineering problems were identified through detailed design reviews and interdisciplinary coordination before execution.*”

SECONDARY EVIDENCE

- **Herbert Simon:** Problem framing is the foundation of effective decision-making under bounded rationality.

KEY INSIGHT

Successful professionals invest time in understanding the actual problem before proposing solutions.

GATHER MULTI-SOURCE EVIDENCE

PRIMARY EVIDENCE

Education

- **Fr. Nobit B.K.:** “*Verified facts using multiple sources before making disciplinary decisions*”

Healthcare

- **Mr. S. K. Ahmed Raza:** “*Combined research evidence with field observations.*”

SECONDARY EVIDENCE

- **Jerome Groopman:** Effective decisions require evidence from multiple perspectives rather than relying on first impressions.

KEY INSIGHT

Reliable decisions are built on diverse and validated sources of information.

BALANCE DATA WITH PROFESSIONAL JUDGMENT

PRIMARY EVIDENCE

Banking

- **Yashvi Pandey:** “*Financial data was combined with professional experience and intuition.*”

Public Administration

- **G. Mouni Sreedhar:** “*Professional experience and long-term consequences guided administrative decisions alongside regulatory procedures.*”

SECONDARY EVIDENCE

- **Daniel Kahneman**
- **Gary Klein:** Analytical thinking and professional experience together improve decision quality under uncertainty.

KEY INSIGHT

Data provides direction, while experience provides context for effective decision-making.

CROSS-DOMAIN SYNTHESIS

Our cross-case analysis revealed three recurring decision-making behaviours that were consistently observed across multiple professional domains.

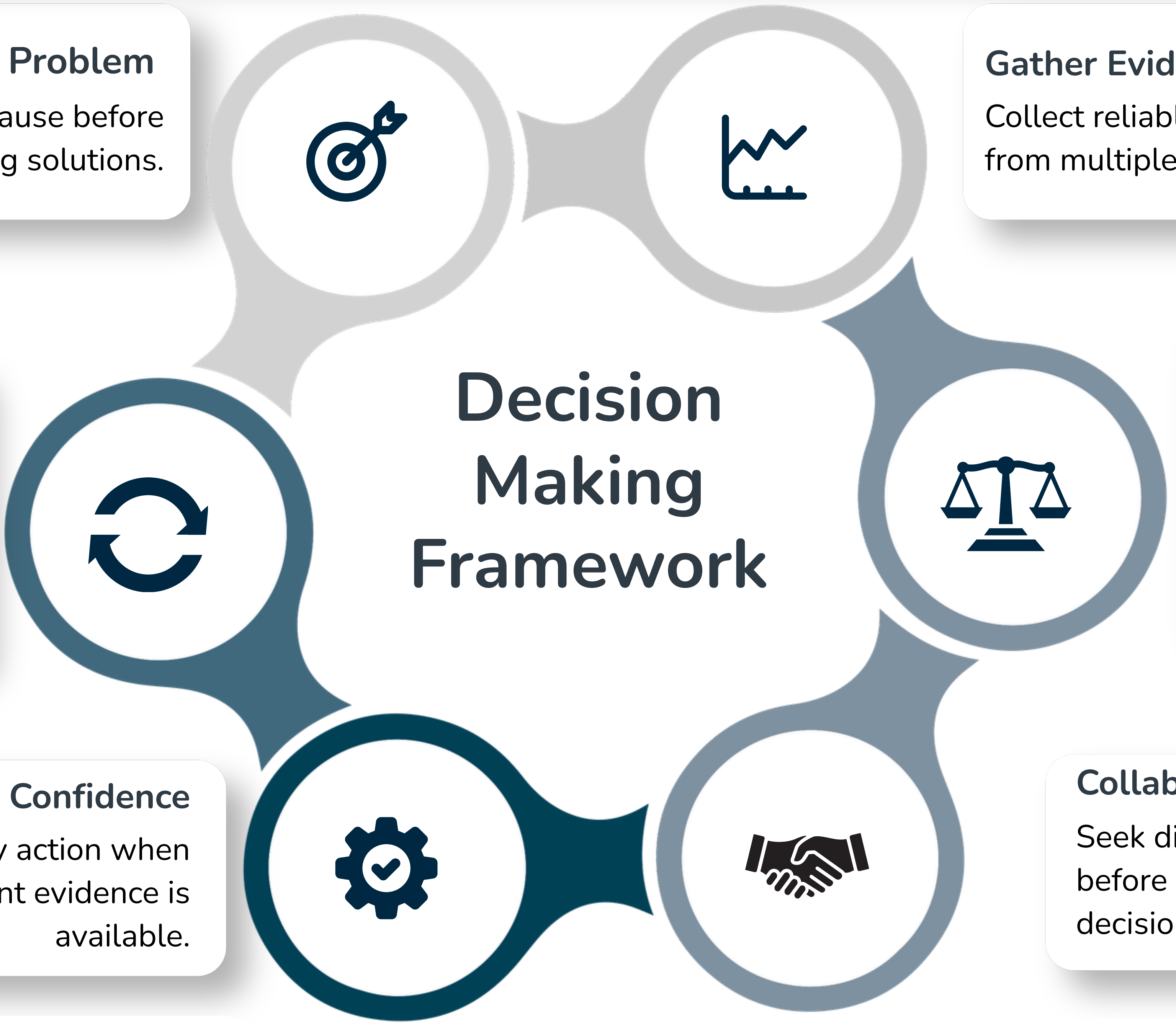
✓ **Define the right problem** ✓ **Balance evidence with professional judgment** ✓ **Gather reliable evidence**

These themes formed the foundation of the Decision-Making Advantage Framework (DMAF), which is presented in the next slide.

Sources: *Primary Interviews (Healthcare, Banking, Education, Public Administration & Engineering); Simon (1955); Groopman (2007); Kahneman (2011); Klein (1998).*

DECISION-MAKING ADVANTAGE FRAMEWORK (DMAF)

OBJECTIVE A practical framework developed from cross-domain interview insights and established decision-making literature.



Define the Problem
Identify the root cause before selecting solutions.

Gather Evidence
Collect reliable information from multiple sources.

Balance Data & Professional Judgment
Integrate analytical evidence with professional experience.

Collaborate & Validate
Seek diverse perspectives before making important decisions.

Execute with Confidence
Take timely action when sufficient evidence is available.

Reflect, Learn & Improve
Evaluate outcomes and continuously refine future decisions.

Framework Contribution

The **Decision-Making Advantage Framework (DMAF)** is the primary outcome of this study. Synthesized from recurring themes across six professional interviews and supported by established decision-making literature, it provides a structured yet flexible approach for making informed decisions under uncertainty.

STRUCTURED
Provides a clear, repeatable approach for complex decision-making.

ADAPTABLE
Applicable across healthcare, banking, education, engineering, and public administration.

EVIDENCE-INFORMED
Integrates research evidence, professional judgment, and collaboration.

Sources: *Team 27 Primary Interviews (Healthcare, Banking, Education, Public Administration & Civil Engineering); Simon (1955); Groopman (2007); Kahneman (2011); Klein (1998); Snowden & Boone (2007).*

APPLYING

THE DECISION MAKING ADVANTAGE FRAMEWORK (DMAF)

Demonstrating how the framework supports effective decision-making across diverse professional contexts.

RECOGNIZE → GATHER → ANALYSE → EVALUATE RISKS → CONSULT → DECIDE → COMMUNICATE → REFLECT → ADAPT

PROFESSIONAL APPLICATIONS

HEALTHCARE
Selecting patient treatment strategies using clinical evidence and professional judgment.

CIVIL ENGINEERING
Managing project risks through collaboration and informed execution.

EDUCATION
Making fair academic and disciplinary decisions using verified evidence.

BANKING
Evaluating financial risk through data analysis and expert assessment.

PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION
Planning policies and public interventions under uncertain conditions.

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

BETTER PROBLEM DEFINITION
Improves clarity before action.

EVIDENCE-INFORMED DECISIONS
Encourages reliable and balanced judgment.

STRONGER COLLABORATION
Reduces bias through stakeholder engagement.

CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT
Promotes learning and better future decisions.

INFLUENCE MODEL

THE DMAF IS DESIGNED AS A TRANSFERABLE DECISION-MAKING FRAMEWORK THAT CAN BE ADAPTED ACROSS SECTORS. BY INTEGRATING STRUCTURED ANALYSIS, COLLABORATION, AND CONTINUOUS LEARNING, IT HELPS PROFESSIONALS MAKE INFORMED, TRANSPARENT, AND ADAPTABLE DECISIONS IN COMPLEX ENVIRONMENTS.

Sources: *Team 27 Primary Interviews (Healthcare, Banking, Education, Public Administration & Civil Engineering); Decision-Making Advantage Framework (DMAF) developed through thematic analysis.*

PROJECT REVIEW & CLOSURE

Reflecting on team contributions, project execution, and key outcomes.

TEAM CONTRIBUTIONS

KHUSHI – PROJECT COORDINATOR
Led the qualitative interview with **Fr. Nobit B.K. (Education)**, coordinated team activities and project timelines, contributed to the literature review, and supported project planning and execution.

ABHISHEK SAHA – DATA CURATION
Led the qualitative interviews with **Mr. S.K. Ahmed Raza (Healthcare) and Dr. Noopur Gupta (Healthcare)**, curated and summarized interview data, performed thematic analysis, and prepared the project report.

ABHIJEET KUMAR – RESEARCH
Led the qualitative interview with **CA Yashvi Pandey (Banking)**, contributed to the literature review, documented interview findings, and assisted in report writing.

RASHI SHARMA – REPORT DESIGN
Led the qualitative interview with **G. Mouni Sreedhar (Public Administration)**, designed and formatted the project report, contributed to content development, and supported presentation preparation.

RAVINDRA NAITHANI – INTERVIEW COORDINATION
Led the qualitative interview with **Mr. Pradeep Jha (Civil Engineering)**, coordinated external participant interactions, reviewed the final report for accuracy, and contributed to presentation refinement.

PROJECT REVIEW

Participation Status
- All five team members actively participated throughout the project.
- No team member opted out or dropped the course.

External Participants
- All planned interviews were successfully completed.
- No changes were made to the external participant list.

Final Review
- All team members reviewed the final report and presentation and confirmed the accuracy of the content and their individual contributions.

CHALLENGES & BEST PRACTICES

Challenges Faced
- Coordinating interviews with professionals from diverse domains.
- Synthesizing varied qualitative insights into common decision-making themes.
- Managing project timelines while ensuring consistency in analysis and documentation.

Best Practices Adopted
- Conducted regular team discussions to review progress and validate findings.
- Applied thematic coding for consistent qualitative analysis.
- Performed collaborative reviews to improve the quality and accuracy of the final report.

RECOMMENDATIONS

- Validate the DMAF with a larger and more diverse participant base.
- Extend the framework to additional sectors such as technology, manufacturing, and entrepreneurship.
- Develop a practical decision-support toolkit or checklist based on the DMAF for organizational use.

PROJECT OUTCOME

The study successfully developed the **Decision-Making Advantage Framework (DMAF)** by integrating insights from professionals across five domains, demonstrating how structured, evidence-informed, and collaborative decision-making can support better outcomes under uncertainty.

Sources: *Team 27 Project Documentation and Primary Interview Reports.*